



Branding is what people say about you when you are not in the room.



-Jeff Bezos



successful product. However, treating MVP as MVP is very important.

The problem starts when someone sells you his or her work, which is still in progress and has not achieved an acceptable working level yet. The solution not working would be less of a problem than it is working against your goals.

The issue with many AI or automation solutions is that sometimes these do not break evidently. These create a leakage of some sort, which is not quite bad but not quite right either. This sort of grey output piles over a period before one can realise that they own a heap of junk. Getting rid of that junk or fixing the completely-flawed system could become a nightmare.

MVP is good and important, but we should deal with solutions that are not ready for full live deployment with utmost care and skepticism.

Auditing the technology thoroughly. Contemporary solutions are more than simply packaged software these days. These are complex pieces of intertwined technologies. Evidently, older ways of ensuring that these solutions are working as expected are not suitable anymore. Quality-assurance methods such as unit testing, regression testing and so on are not enough to qualify emerging technological solutions. We rather need to take a systematic approach, and test the technology for real-life scenarios, possible and impossible (scenarios) both at the same level.

Thoroughly audit the system for what it has learnt, how and from whom, and then verify how that can affect you in the future. Do not just take the creators' word for it.

Most importantly, pull the plug if needed. It is too costly to keep going with bad-quality automation and AI than to just shut it.

Preferring pre-emption over a fix. There are several solutions (for one problem) in the market, even now, at a nascent stage. Not all solutions can be a good match. Sometimes, their offerings are slightly different. Some solutions can provide a fix to the problem as an after the fact (for example, automated fixing of a broken machine), while some would provide an early indication (for example, anomaly detection in machine performance).

Some will help in improving problem-fixing performance, while some will help in identifying problems early on.

Focus and prefer pre-emptive systems than fixers. Both are important, but if you must, prevention is always better than cure!

Avoiding ignorance from the top. People often leverage your ignorance to sell you something. Getting educated on emerging technologies is quite important to avoid these miss-sells. Starting from the top is even more important. Executives should understand better as to what they are getting into. They need to invest some time in acquiring this education to be able to ask the right questions at the right time/steps. Being more involved is necessary; simply learning some tech-lingo is not going to be enough. If you are not involved, nothing else can fix it, ever!

Adding feedback loop and sincerely learning from it. Unfortunately, there is a general absence of experience-based knowledge in the developer community, so we cannot rely solely on data and algorithms to know the right problems to solve. This is a great issue these days, and neutral business perspective is often required to see things through the objectivity lens.

My mention here of feedback loop does not relate to machine learning or AI system as such; it refers to the development and use of value chain. When users provide feedback to creators and creators learn from it to adjust their creation, feedback serves better. If creators consume feedback but never consider or act on it, it remains an open loop system. The open loop system is not a stable one.

Creators and users should ensure that an effective feedback loop is established and everyone in that loop is sincerely learning from it.

As more and more technology is democratised, the ability to create junk (knowingly or unknowingly) would increase manifold. While some will use wisdom in creating sensible solutions that are of great quality and useful, many others would do just the opposite. We must brace ourselves; first to stop this junk from coming in, and second to tackle it, if it comes through! **EFY**